

CS 314: Data Structures

I. Teaching Team

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II. Course Overview

Course Objectives and Content

This class is the second course in computer programming, taught using Java. The purpose of the course is to learn how to use and implement canonical data structures in medium sized programs. These data structures include lists, iterators, stacks, queues, priority queues, trees, binary search trees, balanced binary search trees, sets, maps, hash tables, heaps, tries, and graphs. The course also covers how to implement medium-sized programs using testing; reasoning about programs (pre/post conditions, assertions); debugging; abstraction of data; basic algorithmic analysis; recursion; sorting and searching algorithms; the object oriented concepts of encapsulation, inheritance, and polymorphism; dynamic programming; and functional programming. You can find a detailed list of the [content covered in the course here](#).

We have high expectations for this course. Based on historical data, about 20% of the students who attempt the class do not complete it. Succeeding takes a lot of hard work. Luckily, Professor Mike Scott, who has been teaching this class for 20 years has some [tips for success in the course](#).

Prerequisites

The formal prerequisite for this class is CS 312 (or credit for CS 312) with a grade of C- or higher.

The informal course prerequisite is mastery of the following basic programming topics: data types, variables, expressions and operators, control structures (looping and decision making), procedures (functions, methods, or subroutines), parameters, arrays (1d and 2d), simple user defined data types (records, structures, objects), and top-down design. You can find a detailed list of the required [prerequisite knowledge here](#). Additionally, you should be able to design and implement a program in Java based on a problem statement. The problem should be complex enough that a well designed solution requires 1) 200 - 300 lines of code, 2) roughly 8 procedures, functions, or methods, and 3) the use of arrays/lists of objects. An example of such a program would be to create from scratch a program that allows two people to play a game of [Connect 4](#) on the computer. The display can be a simple text based interface. Both players share the same keyboard and take turns. Try it out!

Flags

This course carries the [Quantitative Reasoning](#) flag. Quantitative Reasoning courses are designed to equip you with skills that are necessary for understanding the types of quantitative arguments you will regularly encounter in your adult and professional life. You should therefore expect a substantial portion of your grade to come from your use of quantitative skills to analyze real-world problems.

314 --> 312 Slide

After exam 1 results are published, students who did not pass the exam will be offered the option to switch to CS 312 for the rest of the semester. The purpose of the slide is to allow students who discover they may be better suited to take CS 312 their first semester the opportunity to do so. Grades from CS 314 before and including Exam 1 will be transferred in a reasonable way to CS 312. A student taking advantage of the slide will then complete the second two thirds of CS 312, rather than CS 314. This is not requirement if you do not pass Exam 1, simply an option for students who meet the eligibility requirements.

III. Course Structure

Lectures

Lectures will be held on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays from 2-3pm (Section 50005) in RLP 0.102. Come to learn the material and engage in interesting problems collectively with the class!

It's been observed over many different courses that attending classes highly correlates with doing well and mastering the course material. One of the main reasons behind this is that it helps keep you from falling behind. All students are expected to attend lectures in person if feasible (i.e., not if you are sick), in order to fully participate in class discussions and other synchronous activities. I understand that in-person attendance isn't possible for every student all the time, so we do record classes as well. The [Lectures Online](#) system will record the media screen and audio during class. These recorded lectures will be available after class on Canvas under the 'Lectures Online' tab in the left-hand navigation bar.

Discussion Section

In addition to lecture, you'll also attend a weekly, 1 hour, small group discussion section (also colloquially known as just 'section') on Mondays. You must attend the section for which you are officially registered (you can find this information on your class schedule at [MyUT](#)). This semester, your first section will be held on September 9th. You can find the full list of the 8 section meetings on the course schedule (under 'Files' on Canvas).

Each section will be led by an assigned TA, who will act as your mentor, grader, and personal connection to the greater course staff. These TAs have personally taken and excelled in the course, so listen to the advice that they share with you! During section you will have the chance to work on smaller programming problems similar in nature to the types of questions that will appear on exams. To get credit for attending section, you must be present at the beginning of your section time. Additionally, to receive credit, you must put in a reasonable amount of effort into solving the problem. Work that displays little or no effort will not receive credit. **Section problems cannot be made up at a later time.** Each section attended will add 0.15 points of extra credit to your final calculated grade.

Programming Assignments

During the course, there will be a total of 11 programming assignments, about one per week. Practice is truly the key to learning programming! Programming is a skill best learned by doing and these assignments form an integral part of your experience in this course. These projects will be challenging, but also fun and rewarding. Your sincere efforts on the assignments will help you develop powerful skills and a deeper understanding of computational problem-solving. Doing well on the assignments is the best way to prepare for life after CS 314 (and the exams).

You will be permitted to work with a partner for some of the programming assignments. I do this for a few different reasons: to encourage collaboration (which is vital to programming in the real world), to reduce the stress you feel, and to alleviate the rush in help hours during the hours preceding the assignment deadline. You are not required to work with a partner if you do not want to; if you'd prefer to work solo, that's fine with me! If you do choose to work with a programming partner, you're expected to truly pair program (write the code together at one computer) as much as possible so that you both *collaboratively implement and understand all parts of the assignment*. It's tempting to try to subdivide the assignment into two parts and work in parallel. However, the exams will potentially test you on all aspects of your assignments, so it's imperative you understand everything about them and not just the parts you touched.

All assignments are due on Thursdays at 11pm on Gradescope. You may submit to Gradescope as many times as you like before the assignment deadline. More information about assignments, including the required format and submission procedures, can be found on the [Assignments page](#).

Late Policy for Programming Assignments

I anticipate that during this semester there may be unforeseen circumstances in your life and in the world that make it difficult to turn in homework assignments on time. My philosophy is to treat you as adults, and thus, I have a generous late policy to reflect the many different needs that may come up for the diverse set of students in this class. However, the course will end for everyone on the same date. As such, if you are late on one assignment, you will have to work extra hard to catch up. Time management can be hard and I encourage you to give it the full respect it deserves. In practice, falling behind often impacts exam scores and final grades.

Due Date: All programming assignments are due at 11:00pm CT on their due date.

Late Days: I expect that at some point during the semester, you may need some extra time on an assignment. Therefore, I give every student 8 late days. Each late day is a 24-hour period. Your late days allow you to turn in assignments past the due date without penalty. You may use up to 2 late days in a single assignment (until you have used them all). After you have used all your late days, any assignments that you submit late will not be graded. On assignments

completed with a partner, both partners will use their own late days and each partner must have the required number of late days remaining. If either partner does not have the necessary number of late days, both partners will receive a 0. To help your TA track your late-day status you must complete the late day portion of the appropriate comment in your source code file you turn in.

The grace period and late days are effectively automatic extensions that have been approved in advance for all students. As a result, additional extensions beyond the grace period are not granted. If you use all your slip days, late assignments will receive a score of 0.

Exams

There will be three exams in this class. All exams will be 2-hour long, traditional in-person, pencil-on-paper, closed-book, closed-notes, closed-computer exams.

- **Exam 1 will be on Wednesday, September 25 from 7 - 9pm.**
- **Exam 2 will be on Wednesday, October 30 from 7 - 9pm.**
- **Exam 3 date and time is still TBD.** The registrar for the class will release the schedule during Week 1 of the semester.

If you have a valid academic conflict for Exams 1 or 2 (such as lecture for another class, lab, or exam in another class), please email Amrita as soon as possible to set up an alternate time. You must take Exam 3 during the scheduled date and time, given that it is during the final exam period. The only acceptable excuse for taking a makeup Exam 3 is if you have another final exam scheduled at the same time. Please note that multiple finals on the same day is not a valid excuse for missing Exam 3.

If you need to miss an exam due to a valid non-academic emergency (such as severe illness, family issues, car accident, etc), you will need to email Amrita and UT Student Emergency Services as soon as possible with the details and proof to arrange a makeup exam. **The reason for missing the exam must be [verified through student emergency services](#).** If you miss an exam without a verifiable, significant, non-academic emergency, 15 points will be deducted from your raw exam score out of 100.

If you miss Exam 1 or Exam 2 with a verified, non-academic emergency and cannot take the makeup exam in a timely fashion (typically no later than a few days after the exam), then your remaining exams will count for the missed exam. If you miss Exam 3 with a verified, non-academic issue, it is your responsibility to arrange a makeup of Exam 3 the following semester.

Grading

You can find all grades on Canvas. Here are the different components that will make up your grade in this class:

Component	Amount	Points per Component	Total Points
Background Survey (extra credit)	1	10	10
Syllabus and Course Mechanics Quiz	1	10	10
Academic Integrity Quiz	1	10	10
Instructor and TA End of Course Surveys (extra credit)	1	10	10
Programming Assignments	11	20	220
Section Problems (extra credit)	8	0.15	1.2
Exams	3	100	300

Your final course grade is based on a score out of 100. Here is how the final grade will be calculated:

- The surveys, quizzes, and programming assignments (first 5 rows of the chart) will account for 10% of your final score out of 100. There are 260 points available in this category, including the extra credit assignments. When calculating your grade for this category, we will use the following formula: $\min(220, \text{sum of non-exam points}) / 22$. This means that you can lose up to 40 points (known as slack points) in this category and still receive 100%. **These non-exam class components can not be made up for any reason.** The 40 slack points are in place to account for non-academic issues such as illness, family emergencies, and extra curricular activities.
- The three exams will account for 90% of your final score out of 100. Depending on the results of the exam, exam scores may be adjusted. The bumping (additional points that are rewarded to all students) and curving (change in the 'cut-point' for a hypothetical letter grade on the exam) of exams is entirely at the discretion of the instructor.
- For each discussion section you attend and solve a problem, you will add 0.15 to your final score out of 100. With 8 section problems you can earn up to 1.2 added to your final score out of 100. This is purely extra credit, so don't miss out on it!

Your final score out of 100 is calculated via the following formula: $\text{Final Score} = ((\text{Exam 1} + \text{Exam 2} + \text{Exam 3}) * 0.3) + (\min(220, \text{sum of non-exam points}) / 22) + (\text{Section Problems Completed} * 0.15)$.

The final letter grades will be assigned for your score out of 100 based on the following ranges:
 A: ≥ 92.5 , A-: [90.0, 92.5), B+: [87.5, 90.0), B: [82.5, 87.5), B-: [80.0, 82.5), C+: [77.5, 80.0), C: [72.5, 77.5), C-: [70.0, 72.5), D+: [67.5, 70.0), D: [62.5, 67.5), D-: [60.0, 62.5), F: < 60.0 .

Note that the final score out of 100 is not adjusted or rounded. Given the slack points in non-exam components, the bumping of exam grades, and the section problem extra credit, scores are already rounded up.

Historically, over the last 20 years, the following has been the grade distribution for CS 314:

- 82% of the students earned a C- or higher: 28% A's, 34% B's, 20% C's
- 8% earned a D or F.
- 10% dropped or withdrew from the class, grade symbols Q or W.

To be eligible for an incomplete (UT uses the symbol X to indicate incomplete) you must have a letter grade of C- or better and a written, verifiable excuse for missing the last exam. I do not assign incompletes so that a student may make up course work.

Regrading

Mistakes happen! So if you believe we have made an error in grading your assignment, you must submit your concerns via email, along with supporting evidence, to your TA within **5 days** of the date the teaching staff graded the assignment. Your TA will review your request and assign you a new grade if appropriate.

You may request a regrade of an exam if you feel the grading criteria was not applied correctly. To ensure accuracy, **your entire exam will be regraded**. Please be aware that **this may result in your grade decreasing**, staying the same, or increasing, so be cautious when submitting a regrade request. Exam regrades must be submitted before leaving the section when exams are returned. To be eligible for an exam regrade you must be present in your section when exams are handed back and you must have completed the exam in pencil.

Course Schedule

A tentative schedule, including the lecture topics, section dates, assignment deadlines, and recommended readings, can be found in the 'Files' section of Canvas. Understand that this schedule is tentative, and I will notify you of any changes in advance.

Important Dates for Changing Academic Status and Dropping the Course: Refer to the [Registrar's academic calendar](#) for the deadlines for changes in academic status. Highlights include:

- August 29: (4th class day) Last day of the official add/drop period; after this date, changes in registration require the approval of the department chair and usually the student's dean.
- September 11: (12th class day) Last day to drop for a possible refund. Last day to add a course. (Note, I typically do not approve requests for adds after the 4th class day due to the pace of the course.)
- November 20: Last day an undergraduate student may, with the dean's approval, withdraw from the University or drop a class (Q drop) except for urgent and substantiated, nonacademic reasons. Last day a student may change registration in a class to or from the

pass/fail or credit/no credit basis. **UT no longer requires instructor permission to drop a class. However, I am notified of the request to drop and if you are involved in an ongoing academic dishonesty case the drop will not be approved.**

- After November 20 students must go to the academic advisors in their college Dean's office if they wish to drop or withdraw from the class.

Required Materials

You will need a computer for this course since we will be writing computer programs in Java. This can not be done on a phone or a tablet. Here are some steps to get started with this course:

1. Download the Java SE Development Kit. [You can download Java 8 from Oracle](#) or [more recent versions from the OpenJDK project](#). In CS 314 we shall limit ourselves to the features of Java 8.
2. Pick and set up an IDE, or Interactive Development Environment. This is a program that helps you write programs. I do not prescribe the IDE you must use in this course since you will be turning in .java files that simply must compile on the CS department lab machines. In class, I will use [Eclipse](#). Some past students prefer [IntelliJ](#) (scroll down for the free community edition).
3. Set up your UTCS account. If you had a CS account last term your account should be recreated automatically. The CS departmental machines use Linux OS. Here is a [simple guide to some of the features of Linux](#). Here is a [list of CS machines you can log into remotely](#). This will be useful if you want to test your programs under the same environment we shall test them under. Here are [instructions on how to connect to the CS machines remotely via SSH](#). There is more information on [TA Sam's 314 page](#).

IV. Course Resources

Canvas

[Canvas](#) will be your main place to access all the resources you need for the course. In the 'Files' section of Canvas, you will find our syllabus, course schedule, lecture slides, etc. You will be able to access 'Ed Discussion', 'Gradescope', and 'Lectures Online' through Canvas, using their respective tabs in the left-hand navigation bar.

While Canvas works well in certain cases, it is extremely unwieldy in other cases. Because of this, some important aspects of this course will not be supported through Canvas. Announcements will **not** be made using Canvas and will instead be made through Ed (more details about this can be found under the 'Ed Discussion' section of the syllabus). Assignments will **not** be turned in through Canvas and will instead be submitted on Gradescope. If you wish to reach me, do **not** contact me through the messaging functionality in Canvas. Instead, please directly email me.

Gradescope

To access Gradescope, go to our Canvas course and click on the 'Gradescope' tab in the left-hand navigation bar. If you're enrolled for the course, you are automatically registered for CS 314: Fall 2024 on Gradescope. This is where you will submit your programming assignments and receive feedback from the TAs on your assignments.

Ed Discussion

Ed is an online class discussion and Q&A forum. If you're enrolled for the course, you are automatically registered for CS 314: Fall 2024 on Ed. You may post questions or comments to Ed (even anonymously) that the course staff and other students can respond to. The course staff will monitor and respond to posts. But, we encourage you to help your peers by answering their questions on Ed, if you are able!

Ed is best for asking questions about course policies, conceptual questions about content covered in lectures, general questions about assignments (ex: how to get started), or small debugging questions about assignments. It should not be used for larger questions about your assignment code (ex: you should not post all your assignment code and ask what the problem in the code is). If you have more in-depth questions about the assignment and your code, I suggest you come to help hours, where we will be able to better help you.

When you ask smaller questions on Ed about your programming assignments, you must include a hypothesis of what the answer might be and an explanation of what you have tried so far to fix the issues you are encountering. For example, if there is an issue in a line of code you write, don't just ask "What is wrong with this line of code?". Make sure to also include an explanation such as "This line of code is currently exhibiting X behavior, but I am trying to get it to do Y. I think this may be happening because of Z, but I'm not sure how to fix the problem." Programming assignments are meant to be challenging; doing this makes it clear that you have spent time trying to sort out the issues. At the other extreme, please don't spend your time banging your head against the wall; if you aren't getting anywhere on an assignment, ask for some help and explain your best guess! Additionally, when asking questions on Ed, you should **never** include snippets of code you have written or answers directly from your own homework submissions in a public post, as sharing code is against the class's academic integrity policy (more details about this can be found in the "Academic Integrity" section of the syllabus). If you need help with specific parts of your code, you can make a private post on Ed or come to help hours.

All class announcements will be made using Ed. It is your responsibility to stay up-to-date with these announcements and the content in them. I suggest that you turn on your Ed notifications so that you receive an email when announcements are made (the email will be sent to whatever email you have associated with Canvas).

Help Hours

To help you in this class, the course staff will hold help hours throughout the week, starting from Week 1. All in-person help hours, professor and TA, take place in GDC 3.302, the 3rd floor public computer lab. There are also a limited amount of virtual help hours. You can find all the times for help hours and the links to virtual help hours on the first page of the syllabus. You are allowed to attend any TA's help hours, and do not have to restrict yourself to only your section TA. Additionally, Professor Scott (who is teaching the other sections of 314 this semester) and his TA's will be holding help hours in GDC 3.302. You are also allowed to attend any of his TA's help hours. The full schedule of the help hours can be found [here](#).

Help hours are the best place for you to get help on conceptual topics or homework issues that are too complex to discuss on Ed. They are the primary resource for when you need help resolving code-specific issues. During help hours, you can come to ask questions about the material, get homework help, study for exams, talk about life with us, or just hang out!

Please be mindful that a large number of students are being supported by a relatively small staff, and we ask that you be respectful in sharing help hours time with other students. One-on-one help is limited to 10 minutes to ensure we can help as many people as possible. You should come prepared, having done your own legwork, and with an appropriate expectation of what the staff member will do for you. Be ready to articulate what you are trying to accomplish, what you have tried/observed, what you think might be the problem, and what advice you need to move forward. You should not just provide a staff member with your issue and ask them to tell you what's wrong. We will attempt to help you with programming assignments, but will not simply complete the assignment for you or dictate code to you. We will give you tips and advice, but will not complete the assignment for you. Additionally, we can answer specific questions on program hygiene and best practices, but we will not do a general style check of all your code.

Sanger Learning Center

The [Sanger Learning Center](#) provides free academic support to all UT students. You can make appointments to meet one-on-one with a tutor for an hour-long session. You get 50 free hours of tutoring at the Sanger Learning Center per semester. During these sessions, you are welcome to review course content, work on practice problems, and work through previous exams with the tutors. However, you may not ask the tutor to write assignment solution code with you or debug your assignment solution code (more details about this can be found in the "Academic Integrity" section of the syllabus).

Optional Textbooks

1. *Building Java Programs: A Back to Basics Approach (5th Edition)*, Publication Date: March 28, 2019 | ISBN-13: 978-0135471944 | Pearson Education / Addison Wesley.
2. *Thinking Recursively with Java* by Eric Roberts, ISBN: 978-0471701460

These are both *optional* textbooks, meaning that the text is not required material, but you may find that it offers a different and useful perspective on the important concepts of the class. Suggested reading assignments and practice problems from the textbook are on the course schedule. You can access some of the optional practice problems online at [Practice-It](#). We recommend that you create an account on the website so that you can submit your answers and test their correctness. Note that all of the practice problems are not available on Practice-It.

V. Academic Integrity

If you copy code from the web, another student, or use a generative AI, that is cheating in my course. You will be reported for academic dishonesty with penalties up to and including an F in the course.

The core values of the University of Texas at Austin are learning, discovery, freedom, leadership, individual opportunity, and responsibility. Each member of the University is expected to uphold these values through integrity, honesty, trust, fairness, and respect toward peers and community.

CS Department Code of Conduct

This next section is directly from the [CS department Code of Conduct](#).

The University and the Department are committed to preserving the reputation of your degree. It means a lot to you. In order to guarantee that every degree means what it says it means, we must enforce a strict policy that guarantees that the work that you turn in is your own and that the grades you receive measure your personal achievements in your classes.

Every piece of work that you turn in with your name on it must be yours and yours alone unless explicitly allowed by an instructor in a particular class. Specifically, unless otherwise authorized by an instructor:

- Students may not discuss their work with anyone except the instructor and other members of the instructional staff (TA, Section Leader or Lab Proctor).
- Students may not acquire from any source (e.g., another student or an internet site) a partial or complete solution to a problem or project that has been assigned.

You are responsible for complying with this policy in two ways:

1. You must not turn in work that is not yours, except as expressly permitted by the instructor of each course.
2. You must take all reasonable precautions to prevent your work from being stolen. It is important that you do nothing that would enable someone else to turn in work that is not theirs. Do not share your work with anyone else. Make sure that you adequately protect all your files. Even after you have finished a class, do not share your work or published answers with the students who come after you. They need to do their work on their own.

IMPORTANT: The penalty for academic dishonesty will be a course grade of F and a referral of the case to the Dean of Students Office. Further penalties, including suspension or expulsion from the University may be imposed by that office.

One final word: This policy is not intended to discourage students from learning from each other, nor is it unmindful of the fact that most significant work in computer science and in the computing industry is done by teams of people working together. But, because of our need to assign individual grades, we are forced to impose an otherwise artificial requirement for individual work. In some classes, it is possible to allow and even encourage collaboration in ways that do not interfere with the instructor's ability to assign grades. In these cases, your instructor will make clear to you exactly what kinds of collaboration are allowed for that class.

Academic Integrity in CS 314

For CS 314 the CS department's policy on collaboration is modified as follows:

You are encouraged to study for tests together, to discuss methods for solving an assignment at a very high level, to help each other in using the software, and to discuss methods for debugging code. Some examples of allowable collaboration include discussions of general concepts from lecture, solution strategies for assignments and help with syntax errors.

You are committing academic dishonesty if you look at someone else's code (current students, past students, or code from the web) in electronic or printed form. You are committing academic dishonesty if you discuss the code in such a detailed level that your solutions turn out essentially the same. You are committing academic dishonesty if use a large language model (LLM)/generative AI, such as chatGPT, to generate or debug your code. You are committing academic dishonesty if you ask anyone to give you a copy of their code or, conversely, give your code to another student who asks you for it.

To expand on an earlier point: you shall not discuss your algorithmic strategies at such a detailed level that you and your collaborators end up turning in essentially the same code. You can discuss very high level approaches together, but do the coding on your own. Realize with complex problems, two programs that produce the same results given the same input will still vary significantly in approach and structure. You are making many hundreds of micro decisions as you design and implement your programs. It is extraordinarily unlikely two people working on the same complex problem will produce the same solution.

Here are some examples of cheating (this list is not all-inclusive):

- Using a large language model/generative AI, such as chatGPT, to produce or debug your code for you
- Copying or referring to solutions from online websites or sharing your own solutions on such websites
- Looking at someone else's assignment code or allowing someone else to look at your code
- Copying or downloading someone else's assignment code or sharing your own

- Referring to solutions from previous semesters or sharing your own previous solutions
- Having another student walk you through the solution and how to code it, discussing the problem in such detail that you are essentially coding together, or doing so for another student
- Having another student perform significant debugging of your code or significantly debugging another student's code
- Having another student write your code for you or writing another student's code for them allowing others to copy or access your solution code
- Copying experimental results from another student or sharing your own

Here are some examples of allowable code reuse/online help:

- You may reuse code you wrote in a previous course, if you wrote the code yourself.
- You may reuse any code you develop with the instructor or TAs in class and during help hours.
- You may use code (with attribution) from the class slides and the class coding examples.
- You are allowed to post on Ed short segments of code (2 lines or less) that are giving you syntax errors in order to get help on fixing the syntax error.
- You may post and share your test cases on Ed, but everyone must *implement* the tests on their own.
- Materials from the web can be looked at for educational purposes. This means that you can read about linked lists and look at examples of linked list code, but you cannot copy any code from the web, or look at any of this code from the web when writing your assignment code.

If you have any doubts about what is allowed, ask us. Ignorance is not an excuse for breaking the academic integrity policies.

Plagiarism detection software (MOSS) will be used on assignments to find students who have copied code from one another, the web or used code generated by a LLM/chatbot.

If you are repeating the course you may reuse code you completed on your own. You may **not** use code from any program that:

- was part of an academic dishonesty case
- you worked with a partner on during a previous semester
- you are working with a partner on for a different assignment this semester

For more information on Scholastic Honesty and the UT Honor code see the [University Policy on Scholastic Dishonesty](#)

Distribution of Course Materials

Sharing of Course Materials is Prohibited. No materials used in this class, including, but not limited to, lecture videos, exams, papers, projects, homework assignments, in-class materials, lecture hand-outs, review sheets, and programming assignments, may be shared online or with

anyone outside of the class. Unauthorized sharing of materials promotes cheating. It is a violation of the University's Student Honor Code and an act of academic dishonesty. I am well aware of the sites used for sharing materials, and any materials found online that are associated with you, or any suspected unauthorized sharing of materials, will be reported to Student Conduct and Academic Integrity in the Office of the Dean of Students. These reports can result in sanctions, including failure of the course.

Students may not record all or part of class, livestream all or part of class, or make/distribute screen captures. Classes may be recorded by the instructor. Students may use the instructor's recordings for their own studying and notetaking. Instructor's recordings are not authorized to be shared with anyone without the prior written approval of the instructor. Failure to comply with requirements regarding recordings will result in a disciplinary referral to the Dean of Students Office and may result in disciplinary action.

VI. Student Support and Accommodations

I ask that all students work with me to create an environment that is welcoming to all people and in which we treat each other with professional courtesy and respect. In this section, I highlight some common forms of support offered by the course and the wider UT community. If you need other types of support, though, please let us know. Note that this section discusses what to do if you face an emergency during the semester, such as a death in the family, and it also includes harassment reporting requirements.

Personal Pronouns

Professional courtesy and sensitivity are especially important with respect to how we address each other, and we strive to address you in the ways you prefer. Class rosters are provided to the instructor with the student's chosen name, which you may update through [UTDirect](#). That said, I will gladly honor your request to address you by a name that is different from what appears on the official roster and by the pronouns you use. Please advise me of any changes early in the semester so that I may make appropriate updates to the class records.

Mental Health

If you experience any academic stress, difficult life events, or feelings like anxiety or depression, I strongly encourage you to seek support. All of us benefit from support during difficult times. There are many helpful resources available on campus and an important part of the college experience is learning how to ask for help. You may begin by talking to any of the teaching team, and we'll help you get connected to resources, or the [Counseling and Mental Health Center](#) is here to help you. Asking for support sooner rather than later is often helpful. If you are struggling, know you are not alone.

Religious Holy Days

Religion (or lack thereof) is an important part of who we are. If a holy day observed by your religion falls during the semester and you require accommodations due to that, please let the course staff know as soon as possible. In order to guarantee accommodations around exams and other big deadlines, I will need notice of two weeks or more. If you are unable (or forget!) to provide that notice, please contact me anyway in case I can still accommodate you.

A student who is absent from an examination or cannot meet an assignment deadline due to the observance of a religious holy day may take the exam on an alternate day or submit the assignment up to 24 hours late without penalty, if proper notice of the planned absence has been given. Notice must be given at least 14 days prior to the classes which will be missed. For religious holy days that fall within the first 2 weeks of the semester, notice should be given on the first day of the semester. Notice must be personally delivered to the instructor and signed and dated by the instructor, or sent by certified mail. Email notification will be accepted if received, but a student submitting an email notification must receive email confirmation from the instructor.

Students with Disabilities

My policy is to fully support all students with disabilities to the best of my ability. At no time is it required that you disclose the nature of your disability to me, and I will not ask you to do so. If you are a student with a UT-acknowledged disability, I ask that you meet with me in person to discuss accommodations as soon as you have your accommodation letter in hand. If you are a student with a disability that has not yet been acknowledged by UT's Services for Students with Disabilities, I hope that you will be willing to disclose your status to me, and I ask that you meet with me in person to develop a plan for your success this semester.

The University of Texas at Austin provides upon request appropriate academic accommodations for qualified students with disabilities. For more information, contact the [Division of Diversity and Community Engagement, Disability and Access](#) at 512-471-6259.

Policy on Outside Responsibilities and Other Circumstances

At all times, we are not just our academic selves but our whole selves, with responsibilities and pressures from outside the classroom. If you find that those responsibilities or your circumstances are preventing you from participating in this class, please contact me as soon as possible.

Emergency Situations

If you experience an emergency situation during the semester, Student Emergency Services (SES) is here to help you. They can help in the event of family emergencies, medical or mental health concerns, and interpersonal violence, among other situations. If you experience such an

emergency, you can contact them through email (studentemergency@austin.utexas.edu) or by phone (512-471-5017), or you may contact one of us and we will assist you with the process.

Please, if you are in an emergency situation, focus on "forgiveness, not permission". Please focus on your needs, and assume we will do something reasonable when we learn of the situation. If you have time to drop us a note to let us know what is going on, please do - but otherwise, focus on you. Documentation through SES will eventually be required, but it does not need to be immediate.

Harassment Reporting Requirements

[Senate Bill 212 \(SB 212\)](#), which went into effect as of January 1, 2020, is a Texas State Law that requires all employees (both faculty and staff) at a public or private post-secondary institution to promptly report any knowledge of any incidents of sexual assault, sexual harassment, dating violence, or stalking "committed by or against a person who was a student enrolled at or an employee of the institution at the time of the incident". Please note that the instructors and the TAs for this class are mandatory reporters and **must** share with the Title IX office any information about sexual harassment/assault shared with us by a student whether in-person or as part of a journal or other class assignment. Note that a report to the Title IX office does not obligate a victim to take any action, but this type of information cannot be kept strictly confidential except when shared with designated confidential employees. A confidential employee is someone a student can go to and talk about a Title IX matter without triggering that employee to have to report the situation to have it automatically investigated. If you would like to speak with someone who can provide support or remedies without making an official report to the university, please email advocate@austin.utexas.edu. For more information about reporting options and resources, visit <http://www.titleix.utexas.edu/>, contact the Title IX Office via email at titleix@austin.utexas.edu, or call 512-471-0419.

Texas Senate Bill 17

From the American Association of University Professors at UT Austin: "[Texas Senate Bill 17](#), the recent law that outlaws diversity, equity, and inclusion programs at public colleges and universities in Texas, does not in any way affect content, instruction or discussion in a course at public colleges and universities in Texas. Expectations and academic freedom for teaching and class discussion have not been altered post-SB 17, and students should not feel the need to censor their speech pertaining to topics including race and racism, structural inequality, LGBTQ+ issues, or diversity, equity, and inclusion."

Looking Forward to a Great Semester!

Genuinely, teaching computer science (and especially this class!) is a profound joy. Thanks for coming to learn with us. We can't wait!

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